

CUNY AI LAB

# Configuring skills and tools

New Media Lab · Room 7388.01
CUNY Graduate Center

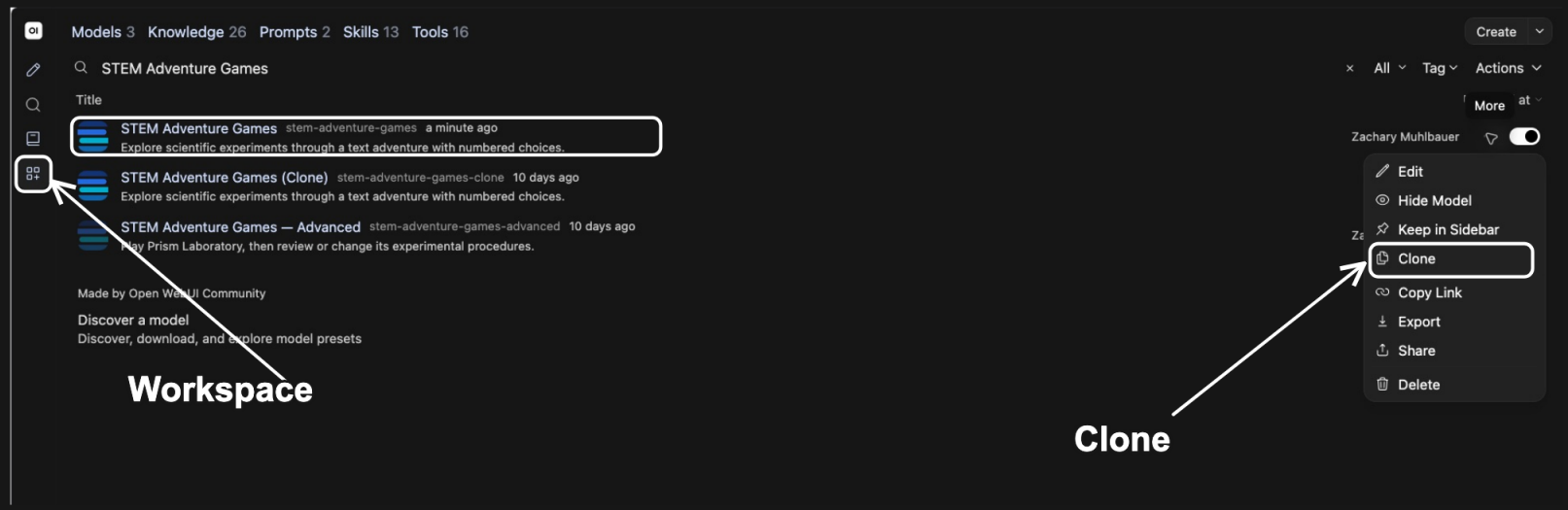
Thursday, October 15, 2026 · 2:30–4:00 p.m. Eastern

**Developed by Zach Muhlbauer**

https://cuny-ai-lab.github.io/sandbox-series/skills

# Choose Your Own Adventure

1. Continue your saved model, or clone **STEM Adventure Games** in **Workspace → Models → ⋯ → Clone**
2. Open **Workspace → Models → Edit** and review your system prompt's setting, goals, and rules
3. Keep your model card open to add a skill and a tool



# What Is a Skill?

**Skills** contain plain-text instructions for repeatable tasks

| | |
|---|---|
| **Trigger** | Request or condition that starts a procedure |
| **Procedure** | Steps, checks, and points that require a question |
| **Output** | Required response content and form |

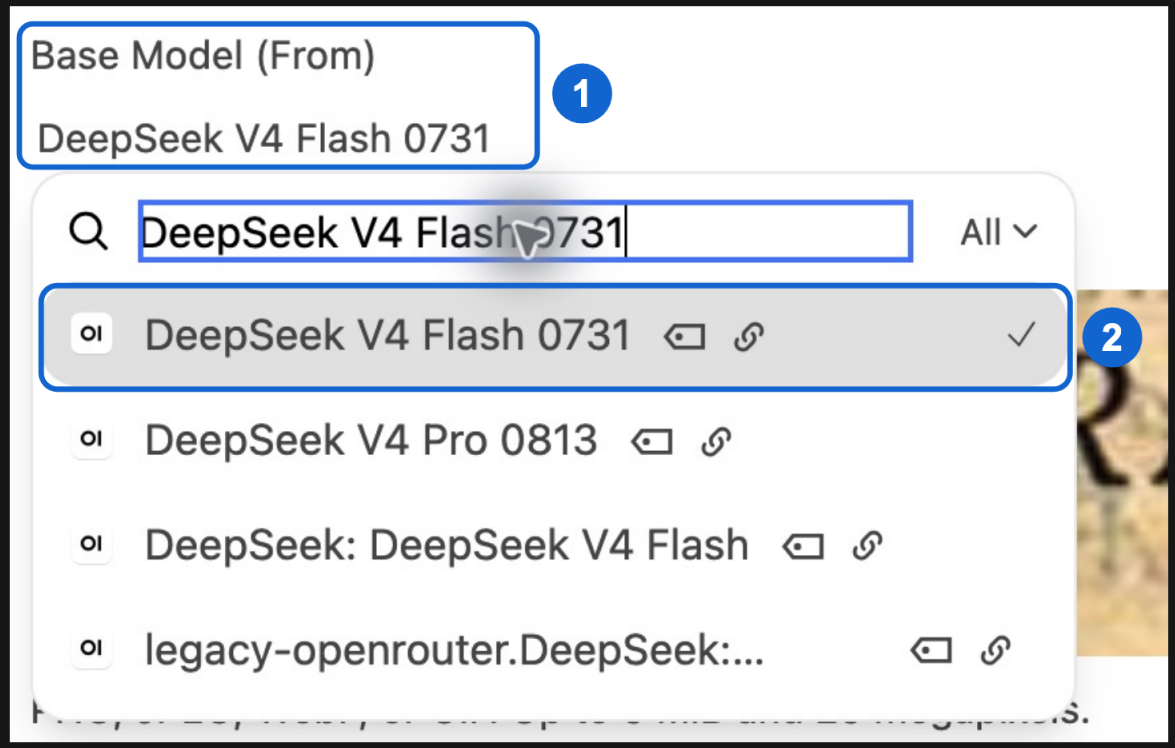
# What Is a Tool?

When a model calls a **tool**, it is given the ability to execute a function and return its result, usually through a Python script

This is called **tool calling** (aka **function calling**)

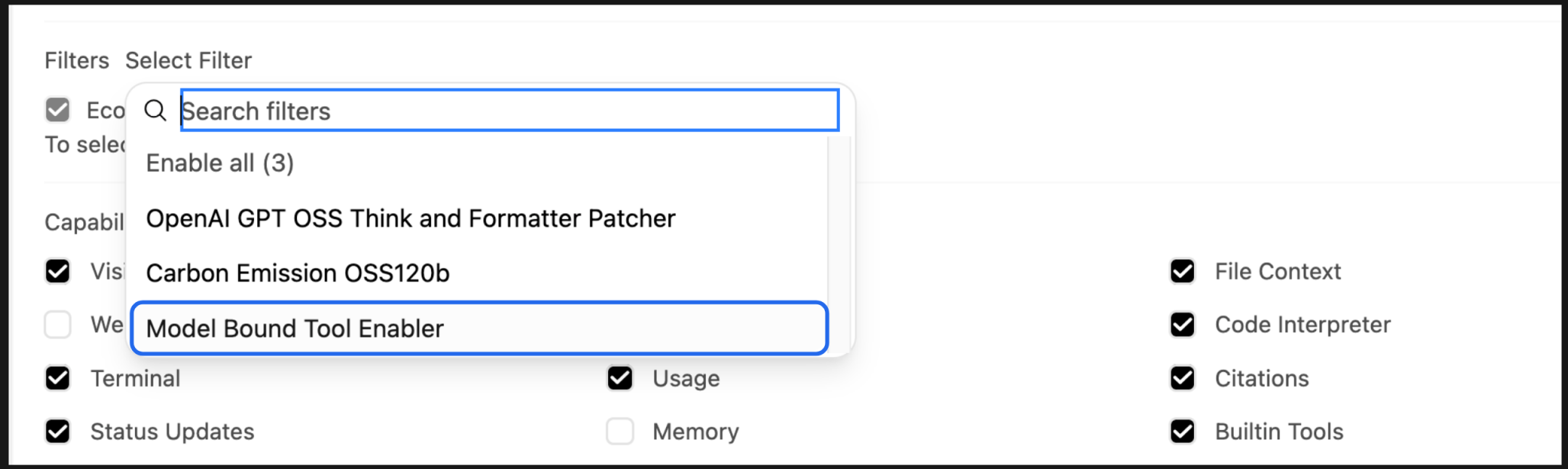
| | |
|---|---|
| **Input** | Information passed to a function |
| **Execution** | Code that applies specified rules |
| **Result** | Returned output for a model to inspect |

# Update Model for Tool Calling



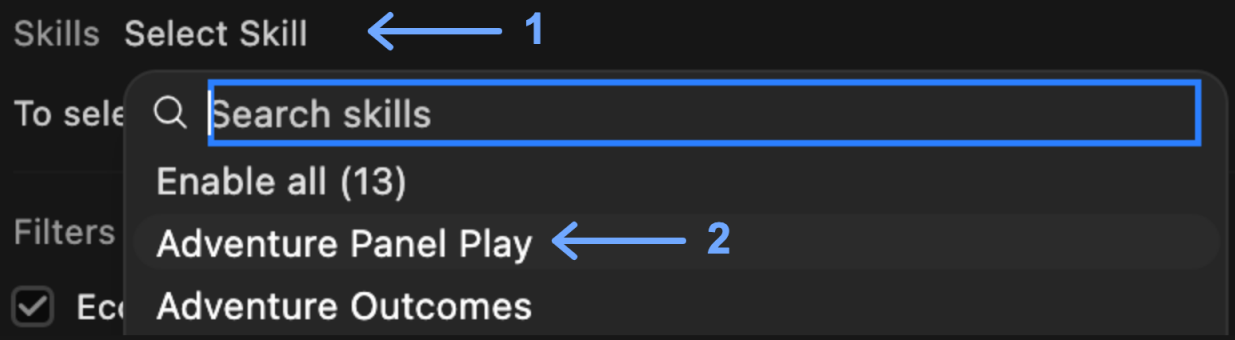
# Enable Filter

Enable **Model Bound Tool Enabler** on your model card, which binds assigned tools to the model's operations.



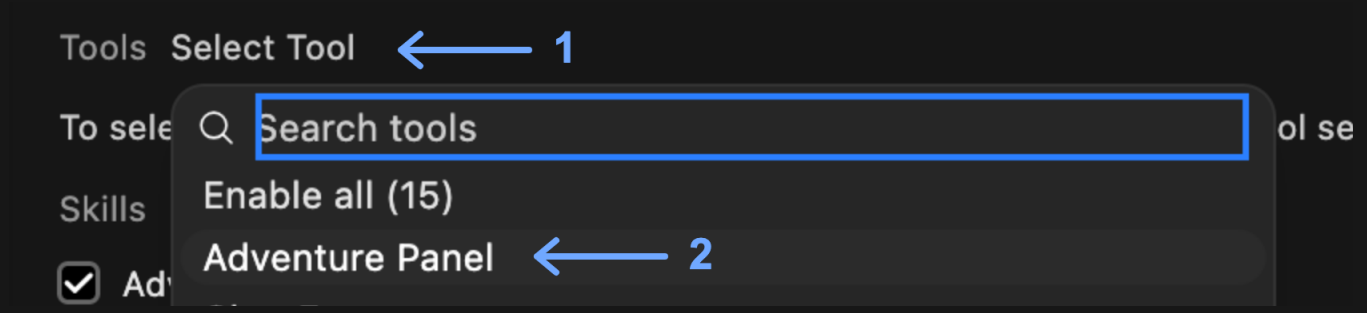
# Add Your Skill

1. Open **Workspace → Models → Edit → Skills → Select Skill**
2. Choose **Adventure Panel Play** and read its saved instructions
3. Keep your model card open to add **Adventure Panel**



# Add the 'Adventure Panel' tool

1. Open **Tools → Select Tool** on the same model card
2. Choose **Adventure Panel** and keep **Adventure Panel Play** selected
3. Add the system-prompt instructions on slide 10, then select **Save & Update**

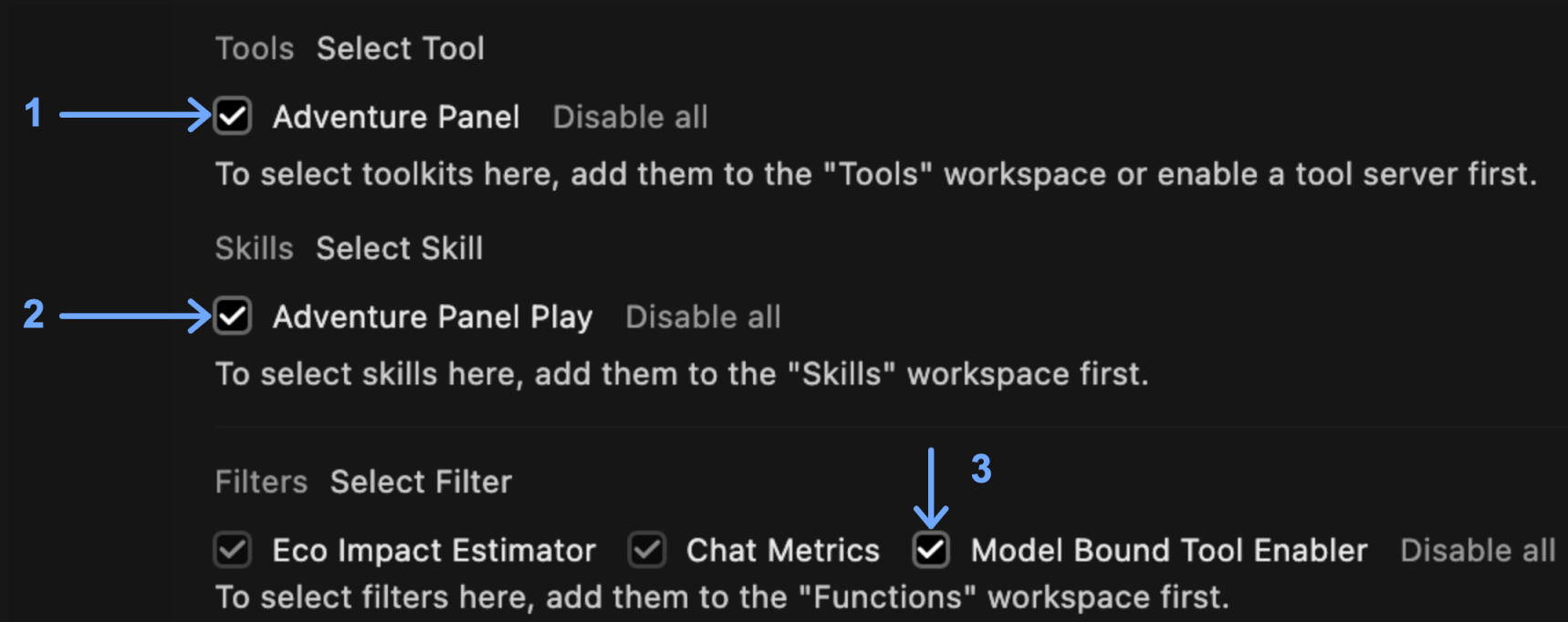


# Model Card Check-In

Confirm these selections on your model card

1. **Adventure Panel** tool
2. **Adventure Panel Play** skill
3. **Model Bound Tool Enabler** filter

Keep your knowledge collection attached



# Add Skill Instructions to the Bottom of Your System Prompt

Copy prompt

Load the attached Adventure Panel Play skill (extend-adventure-games) and follow it on every turn. Use show_scene from the Adventure Panel tool to display each scene and its choices. Follow this system prompt's setting, goals, rules, and source instructions.

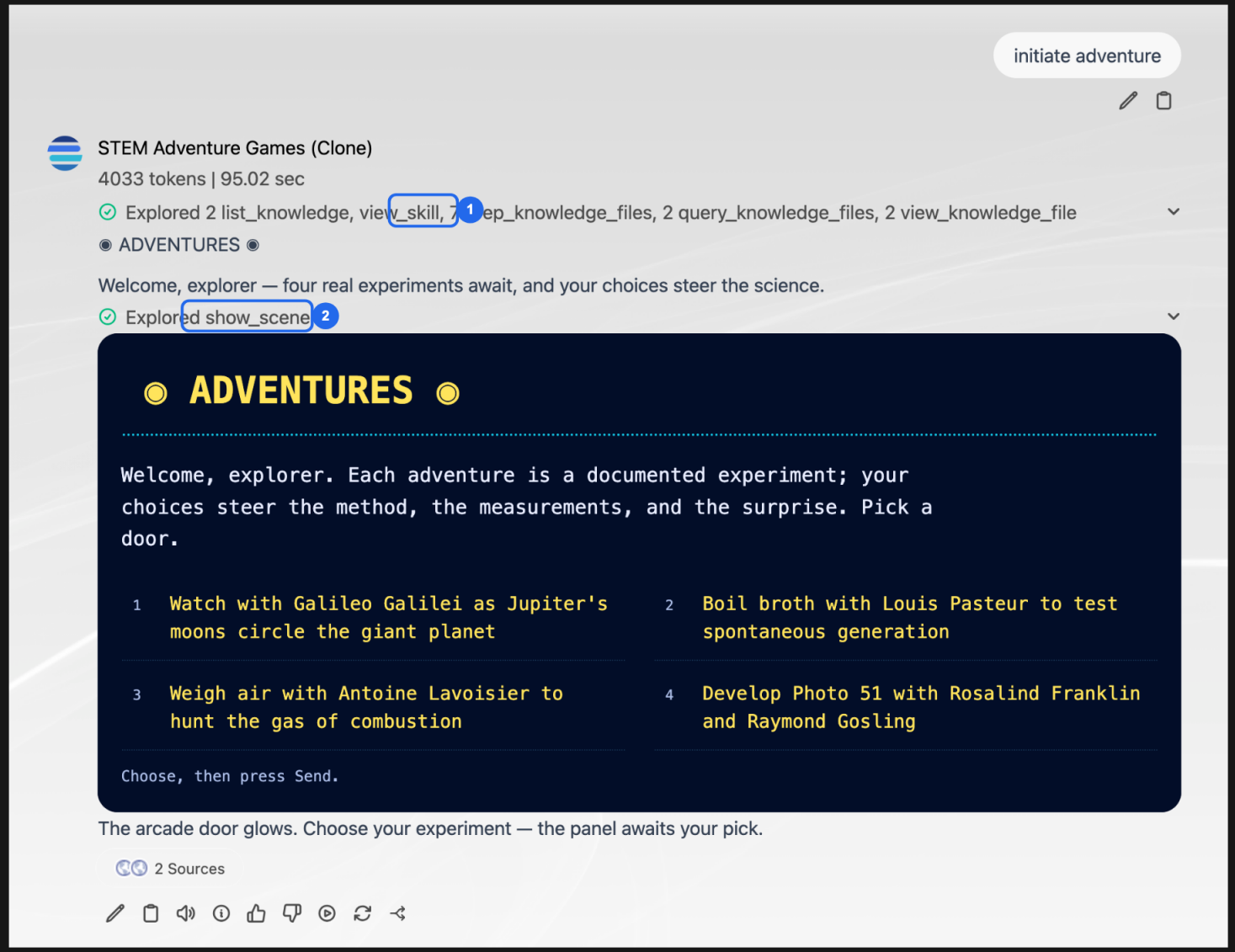
# Test Your Adventure

1. Run your updated adventure game
2. Verify configured skill and tool are called appropriately
3. Then play the rest of your game

# Observe Game Results

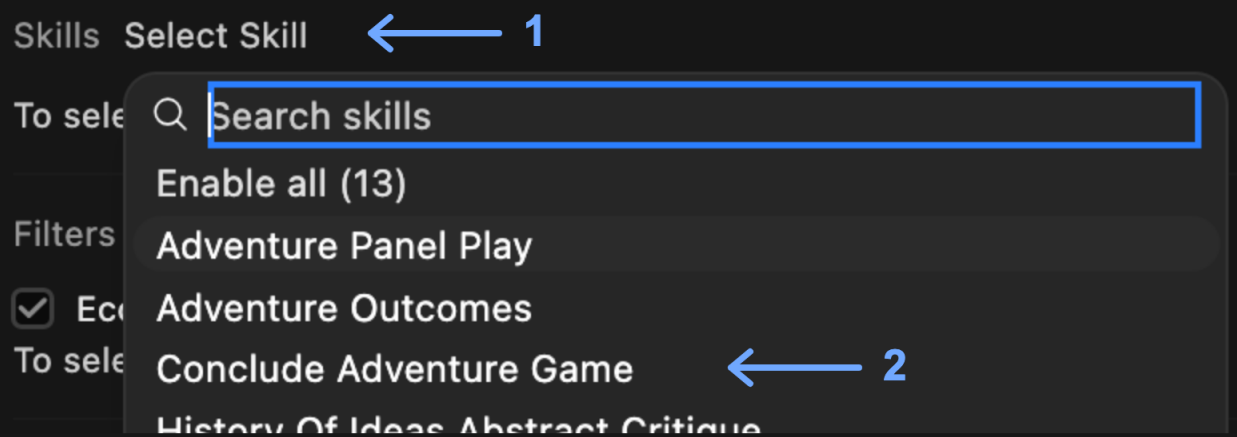
1. Check the **Adventure Panel Play** skill call
2. Check the **Adventure Panel** tool call

Open call details to confirm the skill and `show_scene` function



# Explore Other Skills

1. Read **Adventure Outcomes** or **Conclude Adventure Game** after your first adventure works
2. Change one skill and save your model card
3. Run your adventure again and compare results



# Choose Your Task

## Revise One Item

1. Copy complete tool code or skill instructions
2. Describe an observed problem and one change

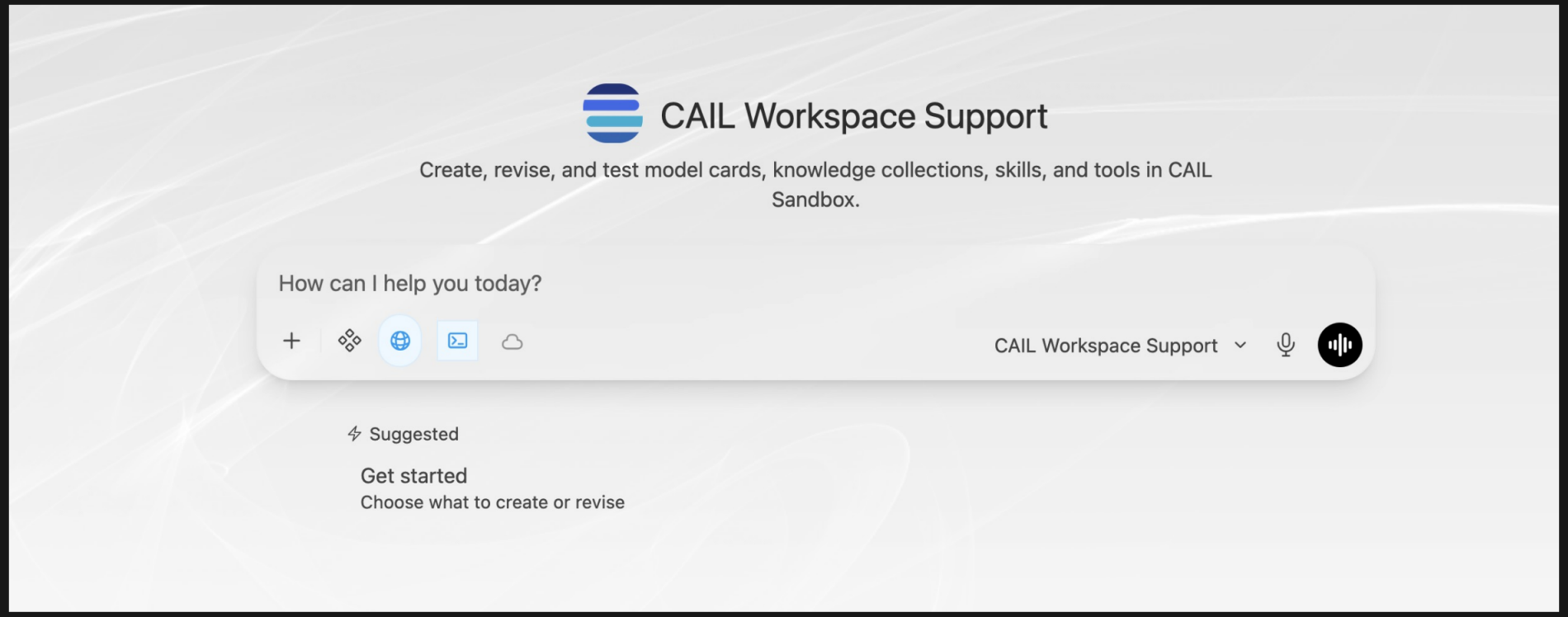
Copy tool code · Skill instructions

## Create Your Own

1. Choose a task for your tool or skill
2. Specify its purpose, required input, and expected result

# Work With Support

Prompt CAIL Workspace Support to generate a skill and/or tool that continues to support or further extends your adventure game, adapting an existing skill/tool or making your own.

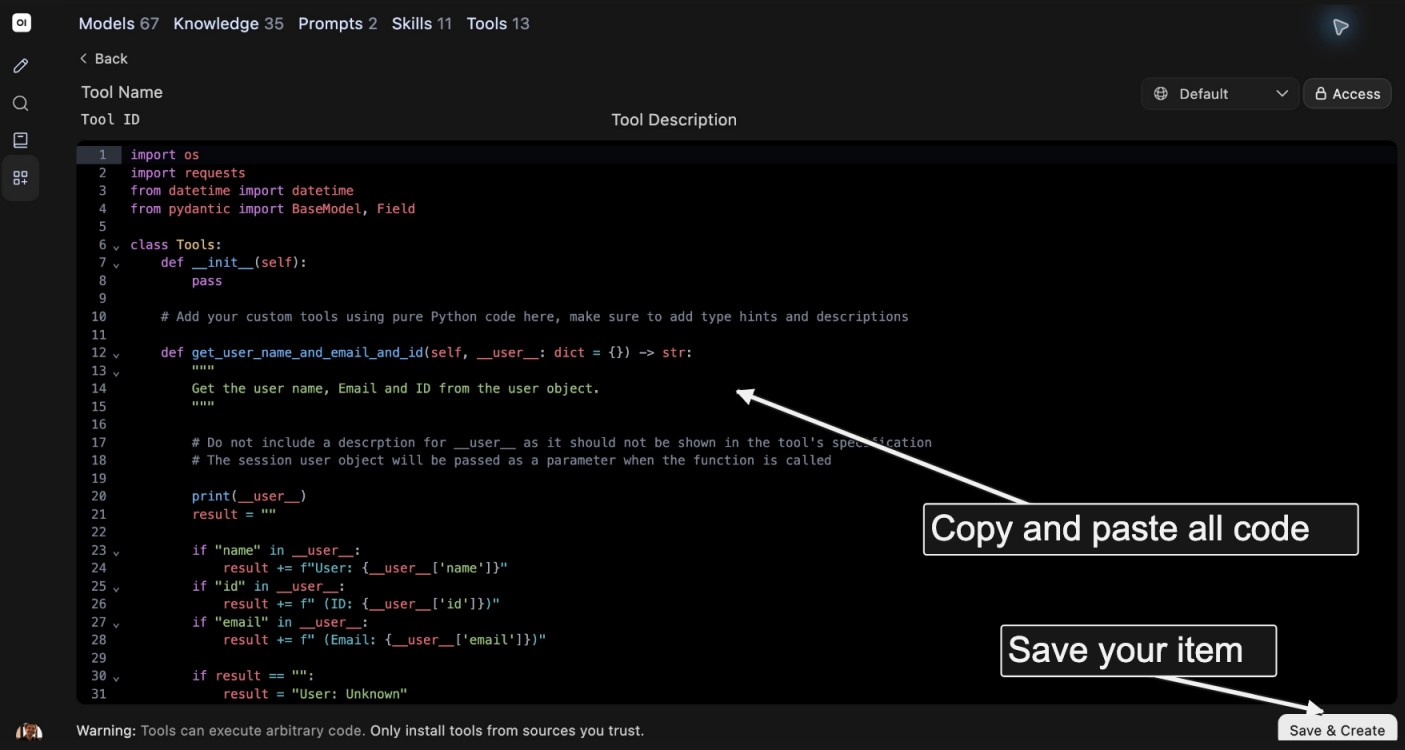


## Adapt Your Adventure

1. Give **CAIL Workspace Support** your lesson plan, learning outcome, or disciplinary focus
2. Ask it to adapt or create a skill or tool that extends your adventure toward that outcome

# Add Tools or Skills

1. Copy and paste all code for tools or plain text for skills, then save your item
2. On your model card, select your new tool or skill, and signpost it in your system prompt



# CUNY AI Lab | Coworking Sessions

The Sandbox Workshops and Vibe Coding series dovetail. Design an AI workflow with prompts, knowledge collections, skills, and tools, then extend it into a working digital project.

Use coworking sessions to bring these approaches together—build on your adventure game, test a prototype, and get feedback as you develop it further.

Workshop materials and guides